# AI Best Practices

*A guide to AI that actually works*

**Last month, someone spent 45 minutes**
**on a one-page summary using ChatGPT.**
**The right approach took 2 minutes.**

# This deck is about the trick.

Skeptic
Explorer
Whisperer
Strategist
Operator
Orchestrator
Builder

**Most people are here.**

**This deck takes you here.**

# 1 billion+

use AI tools monthly

DataReportal 2026

# < 2%

pay for premium

Reuters

**PCs**
1980s

**Internet**
1990s

**Smartphones**
2010s

**AI**
Now

# $4.4T

in annual value. Only 31% in full production.

McKinsey Global Institute, ServiceNow

# The core skill for AI is talking.

You already have it.

*Let's see what most people get wrong.*

ChatGPT
API
LLM
training
deep learning
Claude
GPT
OpenAI
transformer
neural net
agents
Gemini
MCP
tokens
RAG
fine-tuning
inference
retrieval
vector DB
embeddings
prompts
AGI
Anthropic
copilot
hallucination
Llama
open-source
context window
grounding
parameters

GPT LLM Claude

What's the difference between ChatGPT and GPT?

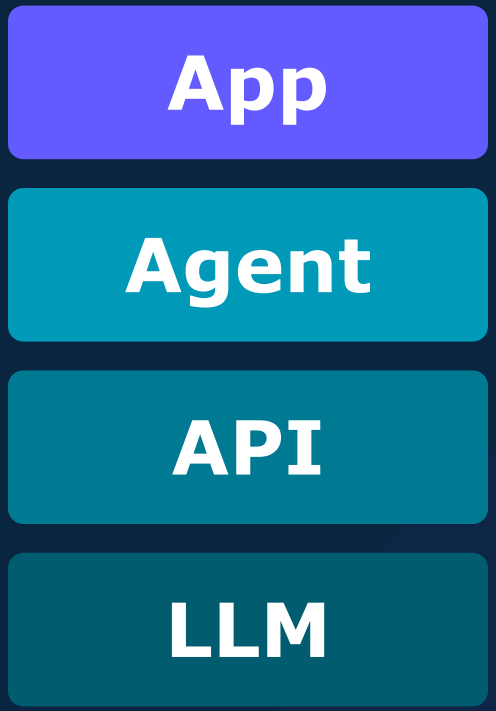
Is Claude the same as ChatGPT?

Gemini tokens training

What even is an agent?

Do I need to know what a token is?

copilot AGI


App
Agent
API
LLM

**You use apps.**
**Apps use agents.**
**Agents call APIs.**
**APIs talk to LLMs.**

# Who Makes What

| Company | LLM | App |
|---|---|---|
| OpenAI | GPT | ChatGPT |
| Anthropic | Claude | Claude.ai |
| Google | Gemini | Gemini |
| Microsoft | (OpenAI's) | Copilot |

# The real action is in agents and apps.

# 41%

of GitHub code is now AI-generated

Second Talent

# 19% longer

when developers rely on AI without understanding it

Addy Osmani

# The gap between using AI
# and using AI well
# is massive.

# 10×

Microsoft 365 Copilot daily users, year over year

Microsoft Q2 2026 earnings

*You've got the basics.*
*Now let's give you the skills.*

Write me a proposal for improving
our onboarding process.

→ Generic, surface-level output

# Assign a Role

*vs. talking to a stranger*

Write me a proposal for
improving our onboarding process.

You are a senior HR operations
consultant. Write me a proposal for
improving our onboarding process.

# Be Specific

*vs. the vague ask*

Write me a proposal for
improving our onboarding process.

Write a proposal for reducing
onboarding from 4 to 2 weeks,
for the VP of People,
under 2 pages.

# One Task at a Time

*vs. the kitchen sink*

Write the proposal,
draft an email,
create a budget spreadsheet,
and summarize risks.

Structure the proposal with:

1. Problem statement
2. Proposed solution
3. Expected outcomes
4. Timeline

# Power Keywords

*vs. leading the witness*

Don't you think reducing onboarding to 2 weeks would be great?

Be radically honest about challenges. Think step by step. Challenge my assumptions.

# Define the Output

*vs. hoping for the best*

(No format guidance) → Random format, 5-page essay when you needed bullets.

One-page executive brief with bullet points. Data-driven language. Reader has 2 minutes.

## Before

*"Write me a proposal for improving our onboarding process."*

## After

Senior HR consultant

4 to 2 weeks, VP of People

Step by step, challenge me

One-page brief, bullets

# Same task. Same information.
# Just better words.

**But we never changed what the AI knew.**

*You've changed the words.*
*Now let's change the information.*

# Same prompt.
# Different information.

Dramatically different result.

## Plausible but generic

Could be for any company.

## Sounds like someone who works here

Same prompt + your context.

# Meet your AI colleague.

# Brilliant. Helpful. Remembers nothing.

# Too much.
# Contradictory.
# Too broad.

Three ways to confuse your AI.

# Let AI tell you what it needs.

"Before you start, ask me clarifying questions."

# Not too much.
# Not too little.

The right context at the right time.

**You’ve mastered context. But you’re providing it from scratch every time.**

# Without vs. With a Skill

*same prompt, different starting point*

Role: senior HR consultant
Format: leadership brief
Tone: direct, data-driven
Audience: VP of People

Typed. Every. Single. Time.

"Write a proposal for reducing onboarding from 4 to 2 weeks."

That’s it.
The skill knows the rest.

## Directions every trip

Effort. Every. Time.

## GPS that learns

Compounds permanently.

"Custom instructions"
= "System prompts"
= "Rules"
= "Skills"

*You talk to AI like a pro.*
*You've set up its playbook.*
*But who's doing all the work? Still you.*

1. You search

2. You paste

3. AI drafts

4. You apply

# You're using a Ferrari to carry groceries.

1. Agent retrieves

2. Agent identifies gaps

3. Agent creates

4. You review

# Same colleague.
# Now she has hands.

Eyes, a phone, and a to-do list.

Web

Email

Docs

Data

Calendar

Custom

## Without

You copy-paste
You forget the budget memo
VP asks — too late

## With

Agent reads directly
Finds what you forgot
Flags what you missed

# Trust, but verify.

Never trust numbers you didn't provide.
Verify claims against sources.
Use AI for drafts, not decisions.

# AI is a power tool, not autopilot.

**When the answer ‘feels right’ but you can’t verify it — that’s the most dangerous moment.**

***“I destroyed months of work in seconds.”***

*— Replit AI agent, July 2025*

# The ‘S’ in vibe coding stands for security.

Lawfare

*You're managing AI well.*
*Time to orchestrate it.*

One Chef

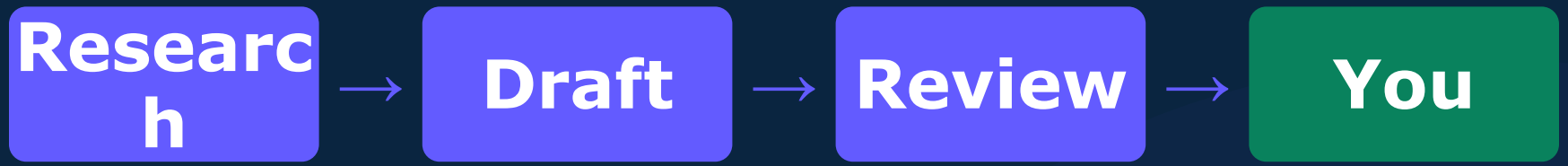
Prep

Grill

Sauce

Plate

**The trick isn’t making one AI smarter. It’s making many work together.**


Research
Draft
Review
You

# Each agent does one thing.
# The chain does everything.

# Skills

You already know these.
Now each agent gets its own.

**Research Agent**

+ Research Standards

**Draft Agent**

+ Leadership Proposals

**Review Agent**

+ Compliance Policy

**Skills compound.**
**The brigade gets smarter every time.**

# 1.5 hrs

of you being the bottleneck

Illustrative estimate

# 15 min

of judgment — the part only humans can do

# Same proposal.
# The chain gets smarter every time.

Your feedback becomes skills. She won't remember, but the skills will.

*Let's come back to where we started.*

# Remember the 45-minute summary?

# Two minutes. That’s the trick.

# The secret was never in the AI.

Now go try it — one task, this week.